WENDI LI

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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin–Madison, WI, USA Sept. 2025 - Present
Ph.D. in Computer Science
Advisor: Prof. Sharon Yixuan Li

Huazhong University of Science and Technology, China Sept. 2022 - Jun. 2025
M.E. in Computer Science
Advisor: Prof. Wei Wei

Huazhong University of Science and Technology, China Sept. 2018 - Jun. 2022
B.E. in Computer Science

PUBLICATION(*EQUAL CONTRIBUTION)

1. **Entropy Dynamics in Agent Reinforcement Learning**
   Wendi Li, Shawn Im, Sharon Li
   Neural Information Processing Systems (**NeurIPS**), 2026

2. **Hide-and-Seek in Trajectories: Discovering Failure Signals for VLA Runtime Monitoring**
   Seongheon Park, Wendi Li, Changdae Oh, Samuel Yeh, Zsolt Kira, Michael Hagenow, Sharon Li
   Neural Information Processing Systems (**NeurIPS**), 2026

3. **Neglected Free Lunch from Post-training: Progress Advantage for LLM Agents**
   Changdae Oh, Wendi Li, Seongheon Park, Samuel Yeh, Tanwi Mallick, Sharon Li
   Neural Information Processing Systems (**NeurIPS**), 2026
   RLxF@ICML 2026 **[Best Paper]**

4. **Process Reinforcement through Implicit Rewards**
   Ganqu Cui*, Lifan Yuan*, Zefan Wang*, Hanbin Wang*, Wendi Li*, Bingxiang He*, Yuchen Fan*, Tianyu Yu*, Qixin Xu*, Weize Chen, Jiarui Yuan, Huayu Chen, Kaiyan Zhang, Xingtai Lv, Shuo Wang, Yuan Yao, Xu Han, Hao Peng, Yu Cheng, Zhiyuan Liu, Maosong Sun, Bowen Zhou, Ning Ding
   Transactions on Machine Learning Research (**TMLR**), 2026

5. **LAD: Learning Advantage Distribution for Reasoning**
   Wendi Li, Sharon Li
   In Findings of the Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (**ACL**), 2026

6. **Uncertainty Quantification in LLM Agents: Foundations, Emerging Challenges, and Opportunities**
   Changdae Oh, Seongheon Park, To Eun Kim, Jiatong Li, Wendi Li, Samuel Yeh, Xuefeng Du, Hamed Hassani, Paul Bogdan, Dawn Song, Sharon Li
   Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (**ACL**), 2026

7. **General Exploratory Bonus for Optimistic Exploration in RLHF**
   Wendi Li, Changdae Oh, Yixuan Li
   In Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Learning Representations (**ICLR**), 2026
   ResponsibleFM@NeurIPS 2025 **[Oral, 9 out of 136]**

8. **Free Process Rewards without Process Labels**
   Lifan Yuan*, Wendi Li*, Huayu Chen, Ganqu Cui, Ning Ding, Kaiyan Zhang, Bowen Zhou, Zhiyuan Liu, Hao Peng
   In Proceedings of International Conference on Machine Learning (**ICML**), 2025

9. **Process Reward Model with Q-Value Rankings**
   Wendi Li, Yixuan Li
   In Proceedings of the 13th International Conference on Learning Representations (**ICLR**), 2025

10. **Reinforcement learning with token-level feedback for controllable text generation**
    Wendi Li, Wei Wei, Kaihe Xu, Wenfeng Xie, Dangyang Chen, Yu Cheng
    In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics (**NAACL**), 2024

11. **Trea: Tree-structure reasoning schema for conversational recommendation**
    Wendi Li, Wei Wei, Xiaoye Qu, Xianling Mao, Ye Yuan, Wenfeng Xie, Dangyang Chen
    In Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (**ACL**), 2023

12. **Position debiasing fine-tuning for causal perception in long-term dialogue**
    Shixuan Fan, Wei Wei, Wendi Li, Xian-Ling Mao, Wenfeng Xie, Dangyang Chen
    In Proceedings of the 33rd International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (**IJCAI**), 2024

13. **Towards hierarchical policy learning for conversational recommendation with hypergraph-based reinforcement learning**
    Sen Zhao, Wei Wei, Yifan Liu, Ziyang Wang, Wendi Li, Xian-Ling Mao, Shuai Zhu, Minghui Yang, Zujie Wen
    In Proceedings of the 32nd International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (**IJCAI**), 2023

PREPRINT

1. **When Vision Speaks for Sound**
   Xiaofei Wen, Wenjie Jacky Mo, Xingyu Fu, Rui Cai, Tinghui Zhu, Wendi Li, Yanan Xie, Muhao Chen, Peng Qi
   Preprint

2. **Multi-Agent LLMs Fail to Explore Each Other**
   Hyeong Kyu Choi, Jiatong Li, Wendi Li, Xin Eric Wang, Sharon Li
   Preprint

EXPERIENCES

Microsoft Research, Redmond, USA May 2026 - Aug. 2026
Research Intern (Mentor: Wei-Ning Chen)

University of Wisconsin–Madison, USA May 2024 - Sept. 2025
Research Intern (Advisor: Prof. Sharon Yixuan Li)

Tsinghua NLP Lab, Tsinghua University, China Nov. 2023 - Nov. 2024
Research Intern (Advisor: Prof. Zhiyuan Liu)

AWARDS

National Scholarship 2023
top 3% graduate students nationwide
Outstanding Graduates 2022,2025
top 5% of graduates
Academic Excellence Scholarship 2018,2019,2020,2022

top 5% in class

SERVICES

Conference Reviewer: NeurIPS 2026, ICLR 2026, ICLR 2025, ACL ARR